



*I can.”*

*A statuesque angel in a silken gown lands beside you and hands you a silvery spear.*

*“This weapon shall aid you. Stay strong, traveler. We’ll meet again.”*

*Traft and the angel fade back into the darkness.*

When the adventurer wakes up, they find the *moonsilver spear* (APPENDIX A) (PICTURE) from their dream gripped in hand.

**Quest: Haunted House.** If not approached with any hooks, Flora instead seeks out the characters herself. She has a job for them: rid the mayor’s house of its evil presence. Regardless of how they solve the problem, Flora rewards them with 200 gp and, if they haven’t been awarded possession of the alchemy shop already, she offers them to take anything they find in there.

## ALCHEMIST’S SHOP

*Hanging above the front door of this small cabin is a wooden sign with a potion painted on it. Like most of the buildings here, a hawthorn tree pokes out of the cabin’s roof in the center, but its barren branches and greying bark signals that it’s dying.*

This shop has been abandoned ever since its owner, the alchemist Siegfried Reinholdt, fled from the village after Katarina’s kidnapping (see “Background” for details).

The shelves around the shop are stocked with alchemical reagents. Semi-precious gems, pickled animal body parts such as newt eyes, and many plants can be found here, though most of the once-live vegetation has withered and died due to months of neglect. In total, there’s about 350 gp worth of alchemical materials that can be used for

crafting potions (See “Crafting” in the rulebook).

Along the counter is a smattering of devices, among them ten empty vials and stoppers, a *herbalism kit*, and *alchemist’s supplies*. (See “Tools” in the rulebook for their stats.)

Hanging on the back wall is a shelf with potions. Some of the liquids have expired, but there are four *vials of acid*, three *potions of healing*, and two *alchemist’s fire*. (See “Adventuring Gear” in the rulebook for their stats.)

There is a fireplace with various iron mixing pots hanging over the pit. Inside one of the pots is a muddy liquid that has little bits of scales, pink flesh, a small claw, and hair. A DC 15 Intelligence (Nature) reveals it to be a *potion of animal friendship* (DMG 187).

## DEVELOPMENTS

A DC 12 Intelligence (Investigation) check notices some hastily concealed ashen footprints leading from the fireplace and out the door. A DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) check examining the fireplace notices a hidden lever. Pulling the lever slides a hidden door in the fireplace, revealing a narrow spiraling staircase that leads to the Alchemist’s Basement.

## ALCHEMIST’S BASEMENT

The hidden stone staircase is a short flight of stairs, revealing the alchemist shop’s basement. It’s pitch black here; the characters will need a light source or darkvision to see. Assuming vision, they see this:

*The short flight of stairs ends just under the shop. The withering roots of the hawthorn tree takes up the center of the room and sprawls all across the floor. The roots are covered in vines and dead shrubbery.*

*Along the walls on both your sides are strange alchemical devices, glass bottles of various shapes and*

sizes filled with strange liquids, tubes connecting them with each other and others burying themselves amid the tree's roots.

Beside the back wall is a wooden desk with piles of papers covering its surface along with a leather-bound book. Beside the desk is a humanoid figure laying down on a metal platform with dozens of utensils littering its sides.

That's no ordinary vegetation growing amongst the roots; it's actually comprised of **5 twig blights** and **1 vine blight** (MM 32). These plant monsters were part of Siegfried's experiments to create effective weapons against vampires, as they are, in a sense, walking *living wood* (see APPENDIX A).

The blights lay motionless on the ground, making them indistinguishable from normal vegetation. They patiently wait until the characters are distracted searching the room (or they're discovered) and then attack. The plants are hungry, having already devoured most of the nutrients from the hawthorn tree while locked down here, and fight until destroyed.

## DEVELOPMENTS

A leather-bound book rests on the desk; Siegfried's journal. The entries describe his love of his Stensian countrymen, praising their bravery and perseverance. and above all, his love of Katarina, the light of his life. He outlines dozens of plans to protect his people from the horrors of the night, especially from the horrible vampires that prey on humanity like cattle. Siegfried devoted his life to this endeavor, discarding what didn't work and always trying out new ideas. The final entries note Siegfried's increasingly desperate situation now that Avacyn disappeared and her protective magics fail; the horrors grow bolder and more of his people die. He ultimately resolves to pursue the foul "art" of necro-alchemy, believing it to be a necessary evil to protect his loved ones.

The desk is covered with a seemingly endless amount of pages discussing necro-alchemy; the art of creating undead abominations called "skaabs." Standing out amongst the notes is one opened letter (APPENDIX C). The letter is encoded: deciphering the requires Letter Frequency Analysis to break the code; for example, wherever the letter "z" appears it should be replaced with the letter "a," replacing each letter this way reveals the hidden message. You can run this puzzle multiple ways:

- The players figure out and translate the entire letter themselves
- The players figure out and translate a portion of the letter, then hand them the fully decoded version
- Let the characters make an Intelligence (Investigation) DC 15 check to crack the code

The letter is written by Siegfried's cousin, a man that goes by "Stitcher Geralf." The cousin voices his support of Siegfried's decision to finally study necro-alchemy and suggests he move his operations to a place called Mauer Estate.

On the metal platform rests a well-preserved human corpse -- or rather, many pieces of human corpses stitched together. Copper plates with silver-inlaid runes scribed on them have been woven into the creature, the rune-bonds used to join the various anatomical features. The strange liquid in most of the glass bottles is the vital fluid, the "blood" of the skaab, made of lamp oil with a pinch of angel blood. Siegfried had this test skaab properly built, but he never uttered the incantation to awaken it.

## TREASURE

Sitting in a corner of the basement is an *alchemy jug* (DMG 150). Siegfried used the jug to produce the oil needed for the skaab's vital fluid.

The various necro-alchemical equipment that Siegfried amassed in the basement could be worth 500 gp to fellow stitchers, but commoners and members of the Church of Avacyn would be hostile to anyone found carrying such items.

## AWARDING EXPERIENCE POINTS

Divide 325 XP equally among the characters if the party destroys the blights.

## MAYOR'S HOUSE

*The mayor's house is a one of the larger and more comfortable homes in the village. The two-story building is built atop a small hill not far from the chapel and has a large hawthorn tree sticking up through its roof.*

*The house seems ordinary enough until you come close and notice that the mirror placed on the wooden door has been shattered. Holy protection prayers to Avacyn engraved on the door frame have been scratched out with a blade, and the door is slightly ajar. The square-framed windows reveal nothing on the inside; the house is pitch black.*

A DC 12 Wisdom (Perception) check notices about a dozen humanoid footprints moving to and from the entrance. The vampires smashed the mirror and scratched out the holy wards before entering the house.

A dark presence has gripped the house ever since the night the vampires attacked (see "Background: Voldaren's Lesson").

**Magical Darkness.** The insides of the house is enveloped in a pitch-black magical darkness that functions as the *Darkness* spell, except that light sources do work to an

extent, offering dim light within a radius of 15ft. – beyond that is total darkness. If the darkness is dispelled, by *Daylight* or something else, it returns 1d6 rounds later.

**Spooky Stuff.** In addition to the magical darkness, feel free to add any flourishes to this haunted house as you see fit. For example, a wall may suddenly begin to bleed, the eyes of portraits may follow the PCs, a random PC might hear voices or see figures for a brief moment before they disappear. Have fun with it!

## THE RESTLESS SPIRIT

The late mayor's restless spirit now haunts the house as a **poltergeist** (MM 279). Putting him to rest is the only way to rid of the house's haunting.

Ralph senses the character's intrusion and stalks them as they explore the house. Though he moves in complete silence and is permanently invisible, the characters feel his presense; the air grows cold, a chill runs up their spine, and they feel they're being watched.

Ralph will make his displeasure known if the party attempts to loot or otherwise disrespect his home by telekintetically shaking or throwing furniture.

Characters can possibly avoid the spirit's ire by convincing Ralph that they are trying to help. By explaining that they're here on behalf of the Church, or that they want to help the people of Shadowgrange, or other compelling arguments that they can think of, they may be able to get Ralph's spirit to back down and maybe even stop haunting the house. If they make a reasonable argument, allow a character to make a DC 15 Charisma (Persuasion) check to get Ralph to back down.

**Spooky Mirrors.** While Ralph is permanently invisible to the naked eye as a poltgergeist, his spectral reflection still appears in the dozens of mirrors littering the walls ([PICTURE](#)).

## GROUND FLOOR

Inside, assuming the characters have a light source:

*Shards of glass and dried blood litter the entryway floor. A hallway leads to two rooms ahead. A bloody handprint trails along the wall out of the closest room and onto the staircase's handrail, which spirals up around the large hawthorn tree growing in the center of the house and up to the second floor.*

The two rooms on the main floor are the kitchen in the back and the common room. The kitchen has been untouched, but the common room is (quite literally) a bloody mess. There are clear signs of battle such as slashed furniture and scorch marks. Blood splatters cover the walls and ceilings. It was here the vampires clashed with Ralph and

Katarina.

Slumped beside one of the walls is the decaying corpse of Ralph Brunn, the source of all the blood. The vampires had some "fun" with him. The mayor's body still wears his *mithral chain shirt* (DMG 187) underneath his clothes -- not that it helped him in the end.

## SECOND FLOOR

The staircase leads up to the second floor. The hallway to the right leads to two bedrooms: Ralph's and Katarina's. To the left is the music room, where the hand-smeared trail of blood leads to.

Ralph's bedroom has everything you'd expect in a well-off village leader's room. Underneath his bed is a sturdy, unlocked wooden chest holding some emergency savings. It contains 60 sp, 40 gp, and a silk pouch containing five tiger eyes (10 gp each) and two moonstones (50 gp each). Amongst the nice variety of clothing in his closet are two pairs of priestly cloth-of-gold vestments with Avacyn's Collar embroidered on the front and back, each worth 25 gp.

Katarina's bedroom is also fairly mundane. Her wardrobe contains a set of battle-worn cathar leathers, the uniform of holy warriors of the Church of Avacyn and functions as *studded leather* (see "Armor" in the rule book). Unlike her father, Katarina's closet lacks an array of regal clothing; she was more interested in fighting and doing in practical clothing instead of playing politics in pretty dresses.

There is an unsealed letter tucked into a book on Katarina's desk, which can be found with a thorough search of the room and a DC 10 Intelligence (Investigation) check. The letter is written by her and is addressed to her uncle, Hanns Reinhart. In it, Katarina begs her uncle to come to Shadowgrange at once, as she needs his expertise on silver and the moon to unlock a puzzle of "great importance." Apparently Hanns has disappeared for years now, but Katarina is convinced that he is still alive somewhere, and this letter is the last of many sent to all the safe houses of his that Katarina knows of.

## MUSIC ROOM

*The hallway opens up into a large ornate room with an arched ceiling. Paintings line the wall, along with smashed mirrors. In each corner of the room are instruments: a piano with a pile of sheet music placed on it, a violin on a stand, a harp, and a bloody flute on the floor next to a knocked over music stand.*

There are a few music instruments in this room: a piano, a bloody flute, a harp, and a *violin of banishing light* (see APPENDIX A).

There are also three paintings: one depicts a canary sitting in a rusted bird cage beside a locked chest, another shows a flight of angels driving back demons emerging from a fiery chasm, and the last one is a portrait of a regal looking man with a handlebar mustache; Bernard Brunn, grandfather of Ralph Brunn.

After messily murdering Ralph, a few vampires sauntered upstairs for a little entertainment. The bloody-handed vampire played on the flute for a bit before they got bored and left. They also smashed the mirrors so they didn't have to look at their own monstrous reflections.

## **MUSIC PUZZLE**

The following is a puzzle using sheet music (APPENDIX C) as props. You can run the puzzle multiple ways:

If a player can read sheet music, let them figure it out

- Bard characters can automatically read sheet music
- Characters proficient in a musical instrument can automatically read sheet music
- Silvia, the fletcher at Fleeting Fox Provisions, is known in town to be a talented violinist. If the characters ask around for someone that can read sheet music, they are pointed to her.

The piles of sheet music on the piano are mostly of popular songs known to Innistrad natives, but a thorough search of the room and an Intelligence (Investigation) check DC 15 notices that two sheets of music buried in piles of paper stand out from the rest. Both have been hurriedly written on with ink (Katarina wrote on them right before the impending vampire attack). One says "READ," the other says "PLAY." Neither of them are songs that a local would recognize. See APPENDIX C for copies of the sheets.

The "PLAY" sheet has a song on it that wants to be played. Any song will do, but the song used during this adventure's playtest was [Pan's Labyrinth: Lullaby](#). If anyone starts playing the song, either on an instrument, singing, or humming, characters feel a sudden compulsion to pick up the *violin of banishing light*. If they do, they find out that they can play the song even if they have no experience with a violin before. Playing the song activates the violin's magical properties (see APPENDIX A) ([PICTURE](#)), flooding the room with light as the *Daylight* spell, and driving back the darkness. The *Daylight* spell ends as soon as the character stops playing.

The "READ" sheet has music notes that, when you look at the corresponding letters, spell out "AGED CAGE". One of the paintings on the wall is of a canary sitting in a rusted bird cage – an aged cage. Saying, "aged cage," out loud opens the chest in the painting with an audible creak. Once opened, a character can reach into the painting (which now acts as a portal to a tiny pocket plane) and

retrieve from the chest the *Strionic Resonator*. The artifact is not whole: the tuning fork is missing one of its prongs (tines). It was cleanly removed; Katarina gave the piece to Siegfried for safekeeping the night the vampires attacked, gambling that the Voldarens may find one piece, but not both.

## **DEVELOPMENTS**

When Ralph's ghost is either destroyed or appeased, the darkness shrouding the house disappears. Priestess Flora happily pays the party what they're owed (see "Chapel") and gives them the key to the alchemist's shop.

Word quickly spreads throughout the village of the party's deeds. Villagers will be much friendlier to the characters, thankful to have strong adventurers in their midst during these bleak times.

None of the villagers know what the artifact is, other than pointing out that it looks like a tuning fork with a piece missing. Flora knows that Katarina was experimenting with something on behalf of the Church, and that the only other people that may have known about it would be her father, Ralph (dead), and her fiancée, Siegfried (fled).

If the characters aren't tight-lipped about the artifact, word about it could spread and may catch the attention of dangerous folk (the Skirsdag or worse) that would be more than happy to "relieve" the adventurers of their new-found item.

## **AWARDING EXPERIENCE POINTS**

Divide 450 XP equally among the characters if the party deals with Ralph's spirit.

Divide 1,250 XP equally among the characters if the party recovers the *Strionic Resonator*.

## **CONCLUSION OF PART 2**

Part 3 begins after the adventurers retrieve the Strionic Resonator. You may choose to delay Part 3 if the adventurers still intend to explore the town further, as this may be their final opportunity to do so.

## **MILESTONE: LEVEL 3!**

If you are using Milestone Experience, then the characters attain 3rd level as you move to Part 3.